

Piano Cheat Sheet

A compact note, chord, scale and duration reference. No fingering is prescribed.

Staff notes — bottom to top

Treble lines: E4 G4 B4 D5 F5

Treble spaces: F4 A4 C5 E5

Bass lines: G2 B2 D3 F3 A3

Bass spaces: A2 C3 E3 G3

Middle C = C4. A clef and an octave number make the pitch specific.

Nine triads — root, third, fifth

A A major: A - C# - E

C C major: C - E - G

B B major: B - D# - F#

Ab A-flat major: Ab - C - Eb

E E major: E - G# - B

Cm C minor: C - Eb - G

Cb C-flat major: Cb - Eb - Gb

G G major: G - B - D

Am A minor: A - C - E

Two major scales — one octave of note names

C major: C - D - E - F - G - A - B - C

G major: G - A - B - C - D - E - F# - G

Duration in quarter-note units

Whole = 4 Half = 2 Quarter = 1 Eighth = 1/2

In 4/4: four quarter-note beats per bar. Rests use matching durations.

Sources: Open Music Theory; Puget Sound Music Theory; Musicca; Berklee PULSE scale references.